AI in the Real World

Data, Power, & Society - Day 19

Full Case I Results & Full Case II Planning

CMSE 492 (aka CMSE 101) • Fall 2026

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Today's Six Digits: 433791



Case Study I: Your Feedback Is In

- Feedback is in **comments directly in your Google Doc.**
- **3 of 8 groups** met the standard on the first submission. *The rest were very close.*
- If your group didn't, you have **one week** to revise: **Wed, Oct 21** on D2L.
- Comments focus on **what it takes to meet the standard**, not everything we noticed.

Revising is a normal part of this course.

What We Looked For

A case meets the standard when:

- Every **required section** is there (including Similar Cases and the Group Reflection)
- Every **DTPA section and pillar** makes specific claims **with sources**
- The case is **one specific, documented deployment**, not a trend

The habit we're trying to "train": **a specific claim with a source.**

What Went Well

Data and Quantitative Literacy were strong across most groups. Some moves we saw:

- Turning a percentage into people: *"99.6% specificity" still means about 4 in 10 positive results are false alarms*
- Testing a company's number against an independent one: *a claimed 90% cost cut vs. 5–10% productivity gains*
- Noticing that **a mean hides the worst case**
- Saying clearly **what you looked for and couldn't find**

Pattern 1: Every Claim Needs a Source You Can Point To

- Put **in-text citations** (Author, Year) on every specific fact and number.
- Every source cited in the text belongs in your **reference list**.
- **Check your sources.** Does it actually say what you claim? For example:
  - We found some claims attributed to sources that don't contain them. **AI tools can mask this!**
  - We found a statistic about one product credited to a different product.

Pattern 2: Practices and Actions Were the Thinnest

Practices: critique vs. constraint

- **Critique:** lawsuits, reporting, union statements, research
- **Constraint:** laws, rules, contracts, certifications that actually limit the system
- Did the constraint **change anything**? If you can't tell, say so.

Actions: who decided?

- Who made the decision to deploy it?
- Who **could have changed or stopped it**, and what did they do?
- Is there a **remedy** for people harmed? What would it miss?

It's possible these might be the hardest to research; that's ok.

Say what you know; use similar cases to make inferences; avoid generalizing.

Pattern 3: Who Is Behind Your Source?

- Is it **reporting**, **research**, an **official record**, **advocacy**, or the **organization's own account**?
- Watch for **commercial third parties**: a company that sells a tool to get around AI detectors has a reason to say the detector fails.
- Keep **claims** separate from **findings**:
  - *"The lawsuit alleges…"* is not the same as *"The company did…"*
- Watch small overstatements: "only," "first," "has proven," "up to $3 million"

Pattern 4: The Second Half Got Thinner

- **Ethical and Critical Literacy** were often general and uncited.
- A pillar should **reflect across** your DTPA analysis, not repeat one section.
- **Critical Literacy** asks you to *examine* a narrative ("AI is inevitable"), not adopt it. **Who benefits** from that story?
- **Record your disagreements:** both positions, and whether you resolved them.

Read the whole document together once before you submit.

Parts of some case studies disagreed with other parts.

Some sources were cited but not included in references.

AI drafted text was still present in some work without disclosure.

Small Things That Matter

- Delete leftover **template text and placeholders**
- Write in the **group's voice**, not "I"
- Make sure the case statement names **one organization** and **one deployment**
- **Submit on D2L.** One group member downloads your tab as Word or PDF and uploads it. *The Google Doc alone is not a submission.*

If Your Group Is Revising

1. **Read every comment** together.
2. Fix what's needed to **meet the standard** first.
3. **Reply to or resolve** each comment as you address it.
4. Submit the **revised Part B on D2L by Wed, Oct 21.**

Not sure what a comment means? Ask us.

Carry It Into Full Case II

- **Full Case II Update (Part A)** is due **Sun, Oct 18**
- In **Question 8**, say how you're avoiding the problem your Full Case I feedback flagged
- Two things to push on this round:
  - **Source variety:** court filings, settlements, and regulator reports, not only news
  - **Who could stop it:** the regulator, court, or union that acted (or didn't)

Today

1. **Read** your Case Study I feedback *(~10 min)*
2. **Revising groups:** make a plan and divide up the fixes
3. **Everyone:** keep narrowing Full Case II from **domain → case**
4. Work on **Part A** of your Full Case II tab

We'll be circulating. Ask us anything.

Exit Ticket Today

- **Today is a Wednesday, so there is an Exit Ticket.**
- Complete it on **D2L** by **11:59pm today**.
- You need to be in class to earn credit.

Reminders

- **Wed, Oct 14 (today):** Exit Ticket
- **Fri, Oct 16:** Complete Part A of the Full Case II template in class
- **Sun, Oct 18:** Full Case II Update (Part A) due
- **Sun, Oct 18:** Week 7 Individual Effort & Metacognitive Report due
- **Sun, Oct 18:** Week 8 domain review → Forum Post due (*different* domain)
- **Wed, Oct 21:** Revised Case Study I due (if needed)
- **Sun, Oct 25:** Full Case II Complete (Part B) due
- **Fri, Nov 6:** Case Design Scaffold 2 due